

Chapter 167-3

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Chen Mian also drank all night at home, drunk the entire night.

She had "Flock of Lonely Birds" playing on repeat.

On the canvas, she had painted the same person she'd been painting for decades.

Chen Mian dreamed of Qi Jiao—a Qi Jiao who was talking and laughing cheerfully.

When she woke from the dream, it was all empty. "Flock of Lonely Birds" was reaching its end, stopping right at those lyrics:

"The lonely bird flies into the galaxy, boarding a ship

Someone raises the sail

Someone waits at the other end"

Chen Mian called Gu Xingyue like a madwoman, asking if she had ever heard "Flock of Lonely Birds."

Gu Xingyue was taken aback and told her no.

The image of Qi Jiao from the dream kept appearing in Chen Mian's mind. Then she called Liang Shi to confirm.

Everything was real.

But it seemed like there was nothing she could do about it anymore.

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Liang Shi didn't know what had happened between Chen Mian and Liang Wanwan.

She just found it strange.

Later, when she asked Xu Qingzhu, Xu Qingzhu mysteriously refused to tell her, only saying she was too dense.

Liang Shi: "..."

"Really." Liang Shi said very earnestly, "Before I met you, I always thought I was pretty smart."

Xu Qingzhu glanced at her. "You are pretty smart."

Liang Shi: "Then why did you call me dense?"

Xu Qingzhu paused for a moment. "You're only dense when it comes to matters of the heart."

Liang Shi: "..."

Liang Shi pinched her waist. "Who told you to learn so fast?"

Xu Qingzhu was tickled and kept burrowing into her arms. "You're a poor student yourself. How can you blame the top student for your own slow learning?"

Liang Shi tickled her waist again. Xu Qingzhu turned around, and her teeth landed on Liang Shi's collarbone, bumping against it.

Xu Qingzhu gasped sharply. Startled, Liang Shi immediately pulled her hands back and didn't dare to play around anymore. She asked urgently, "Are you okay?"

Xu Qingzhu buried herself in Liang Shi's neck and let out a muffled grunt, not saying anything.

Liang Shi tried to look at her, thinking she might have hurt herself somewhere. But Xu Qingzhu refused to lift her head no matter what, staying buried in Liang Shi's neck.

Liang Shi apologized to her. "I'm sorry."

As soon as she finished speaking, she suddenly felt something wet on her collarbone.

"What are you doing?" Liang Shi's throat moved slightly. The sound of her swallowing was especially clear in the quiet room.

Xu Qingzhu's voice was very low. "You hurt my teeth, so I have to get payback with my tongue."

Liang Shi: "..."

Xu Qingzhu happened to look up at her slightly. Those eyes were sparkling. Liang Shi suddenly curved her lips into a light smile, then slowly leaned down.

She gave Xu Qingzhu a light peck on the lips. "Still want payback now?"

Xu Qingzhu: "...But..."

Before she could finish speaking, her words were completely swallowed up.

Liang Shi kept protecting the small of her back.

When the kiss ended, Xu Qingzhu buried herself in her neck to catch her breath. After a while, she moved close to Liang Shi's ear and whispered something.

Liang Shi's ears suddenly turned red.

Xu Qingzhu pressed her lips together. "Why are you blushing?"

Liang Shi: "..."

What Xu Qingzhu had just said was: "I kind of want to. Do you want to?"

Liang Shi didn't speak for a long time. Xu Qingzhu turned to walk toward the bedroom, but as soon as she stood up from the sofa, Liang Shi grabbed her.

"What? You don't want to do it, so let me go." Xu Qingzhu said petulantly.

Liang Shi answered her in a low voice, "I do want to."

Then she added, "You were just too direct. I was embarrassed."

Xu Qingzhu: "I was already being very restrained. Is desire something so hard to talk about?"

Liang Shi: "..."

"Everyone has desires." Xu Qingzhu said, "We all learned this in health class. Did you never take health class?"

Liang Shi: "..."

Xu Qingzhu shook her head helplessly and said with a hint of exasperation, "You blockhead."

Liang Shi: "..."

Liang Shi couldn't help herself. She leaned down and bit her earlobe.

Xu Qingzhu: "What are you doing?"

Liang Shi scooped her up in her arms. "Satisfying your desires."

Xu Qingzhu buried herself in her embrace and said in a low voice, "But... be careful of the baby."

Liang Shi licked her lips, her voice barely audible. "I can still take care of you."

Xu Qingzhu: "?"

"What did you say?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi set her down on the bed, then leaned close to her ear and repeated it.

This time it was Xu Qingzhu's ears that burned hot.

How did it feel like... Liang Shi was actually the one who knew more?